

DID YOU
KNOW?

The coronation crown (St. Edward's) weighs 5.5 lb (2.5 kg)—as heavy as a bag of potatoes!

There was plenty of time for planning, since the coronation was not to be held until June 2, 1953. As the day drew near, excitement grew. Soldiers were prepared for the ceremony and drilled to perfection. Uniforms and robes were brushed, buttons polished, horses groomed, and the coronation coach wheeled out for its first outing since 1937. Londoners put out flags, and people hung red, white, and blue buntings over houses and in streets across the country. People rushed to buy TV sets, since the coronation would be televised for the first time. This was a change the Queen had approved, when some had said TV cameras would intrude on the traditional ceremony. Elizabeth rehearsed very carefully what she would have to say and do. She even pinned sheets to her shoulders to practice walking with the coronation robe

